

FABLE

Parable of the Rooster

A rooster believed he was greater than all the other animals. He bullied the chickens, attacked cats and dogs, and even ordered the goats and the carabao around. Proud of his victories, he declared that he would rule humans too. One day, he attacked a woman, but she quickly grabbed him by the neck and carried him to her kitchen. Before the rooster could escape, he was cooked into a pot of hot tinola and his pride became the cause of his downfall.

The Day the Frogs Cried

Barrio Sapa was a peaceful kingdom where King Frog and many animals lived happily in a clean forest. One day, a man from the city built a factory, cutting down trees and polluting the water and air. King Frog asked the animals to move farther away, but they continued to become sick and eventually died because of the pollution. King Frog confronted the man, but he refused to stop, saying it was the price of progress. Heartbroken by the death of his kingdom, King Frog and the other frogs cried for many days. Soon, heavy rains caused floods, erosion, and landslides that destroyed the factory, and the polluted land was finally freed from the man who had ruined it.

The Fox and the Grapes

A hungry Fox saw some fine bunches of grapes hanging from a vine trained along a high trellis. He did his best to reach them by jumping as high as he could into the air, but it was all in vain, for they were just out of reach. So he gave up trying and walked away with an air of dignity, remarking, “I thought those grapes were ripe, but I see now they are quite sour.

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The Fox and the Crow

A Crow stole a piece of cheese and flew to a tree to enjoy it. A Fox saw her and wanted the cheese for himself.

“What a beautiful bird you are!” said the Fox. “Your feathers are magnificent. If your voice is as lovely as your appearance, you must surely be the queen of birds.”

The Crow, pleased by the praise, opened her beak to sing. As soon as she did, the cheese fell to the ground. The Fox quickly grabbed it and said, “Thank you. That was exactly what I wanted.”

The Hare and the Tortoise

A Hare laughed at a slow-moving Tortoise.

“I can beat you in a race,” said the Tortoise.

The Hare laughed but agreed. When the race began, the Hare ran far ahead. Feeling confident, he lay down under a tree and fell asleep.

The Tortoise kept walking, slowly but steadily, without stopping. By the time the Hare woke up and ran as fast as he could, the Tortoise had already crossed the finish line.

The Goose That Laid the Golden Eggs

A man and his wife owned a Goose that laid one golden egg every day. Although this made them rich, they became greedy and thought the Goose must contain a great lump of gold inside.

They killed the Goose to get all the gold at once. But when they opened it, they found it was just like any other goose. By trying to become rich too quickly, they lost the steady source of their wealth.

The Ant and the Grasshopper

All summer long, the Ant worked hard gathering food and storing it for the winter. The Grasshopper spent his days singing and playing. When winter came, the Grasshopper had no food and begged the Ant for something to eat. The Ant replied, "While I worked, you played. Now I have enough for the winter, but you did not prepare."

The Grasshopper realized that he should have worked while there was still time.

The Grateful Deer

A Fable Adapted by the Author

Once upon a time, in a lush green forest, lived a young deer named Luna. She was known for beautiful coat and gentle nature. Luna loved frolic and playing with friends. She was the most attractive creature around, and people always enjoyed her company. On one sunny afternoon, while wandering to an unknown place in the forest, she got trapped in a hunter's net as she wandered too close to a human village. She tried with all her might, but the more she struggled, the tighter the net became. Panic enveloped Luna like a shroud.

As Luna was on the brink of despair, a wise old owl named Orla, who often watched over the forest from her high perch, flew down and asked, "Why are you in such a hurry, young one?"

Luna's voice trembled, but even more fearful had her eyes appeared as she replied, "I am trying to free myself, but can't do it without aid. Come help me, Orla!"

Orla, known for her wisdom and kindness, nodded solemnly. "Stay calm, Luna. I will help you." With her sharp beak, Orla began to carefully cut the net, making sure not to hurt Luna. It took time and patience, but eventually, Luna was free.

The deer, overwhelmed with relief and gratitude, bowed her head and said, "Thank you, Orla. I will never forget your kindness."

Orla smiled warmly and said, "Always remember to express your gratitude. It strengthens the bonds we share and brings joy to our hearts."

From that day on, Luna made sure to express her appreciation to everyone who helped her. She would often bring small gifts of fresh leaves to her friends and thank them for their kindness with heartfelt words. "Thank you for being such a good friend," she would say to the squirrels who shared their acorns or the birds who sang to cheer her up.

The forest animals noticed Luna's habit and started helping each other more, all because Luna showed them the power of gratitude. The more they helped one another, the happier and more harmonious the forest became. The birds sang sweeter songs, the squirrels shared their food more generously, and even the usually grumpy old bear smiled more often.

As time passed, the forest became a happier place, where animals supported one another and expressed their thankfulness openly. Luna learned that gratitude was a gift that kept on giving, creating a ripple effect of kindness throughout the forest. The animals found that expressing gratitude not only made others feel good but also made their own hearts lighter and their spirits brighter.

One day, a fierce storm struck the forest, causing trees to fall and homes to be destroyed. The animals came together, helping each other rebuild and recover. Luna grateful for the safety of her friends and family, worked tirelessly to assist those in need. She realized that gratitude wasn't just about saying thank you; it was about showing appreciation through actions.

The forest animals rebuilt their homes stronger than before, their bonds of friendship and community even tighter. Luna's lesson of gratitude had taught them all the importance of helping each other and being thankful for the blessings they had, even in difficult times.

Bruce and the Spider

There was once a king of Scotland whose name was Robert Bruce. He needed to be both brave and wise because the times in which he lived were wild and rude. The King of England was at war with him and had led a great army into Scotland to drive him out of the land.

Battle after battle had been fought. Six times Bruce had led his brave little army against his foes and six times his men had been beaten and driven into flight. At last his army was scattered, and he was forced to hide in the woods and in lonely places among the mountains.

One rainy day, Bruce lay on the ground under a crude shed listening to the patter of the drops on the roof above him. He was tired and unhappy. He was ready to give up all hope. It seemed to him that there was no use for him to try to do anything more.

As he lay thinking, he saw a spider over his head making ready to weave her web. He watched her as she toiled slowly and with great care. Six times she tried to throw her frail thread from one beam to another, and six times it fell short.

“Poor thing,” said Bruce: “you, too, know what it is to fail.”

But the spider did not lose hope with the sixth failure. With still more care, she made ready to try for the seventh time. Bruce almost forgot his own troubles as he watched her swing herself out upon the slender line. Would she fail again? No! The thread was carried safely to the beam and fastened there.

“I, too, will try a seventh time!” cried Bruce.

He arose and called his men together. He told them of his plans and sent them out with messages of cheer to his disheartened people. Soon there was an army of brave Scotchmen around him. Another battle was fought, and the King of England was retreated to his own country.

After that day, no one by the name of Bruce would ever hurt a spider. The lesson which the little creature had taught the king was never forgotten.

Susie and Rover

“Mama,” said Susie Dean one summer’s morning, “may I go to the woods and pick berries?”

“Yes,” replied Mrs. Dean, “but you must take Rover with you.” Susie brought her little basket, and her mother packed a nice lunch for her. She tied down the cover and fastened a tin cup to it. The little girl called Rover—a great Newfoundland dog—and gave him a tin pail to carry. “If I bring it home full, mama,” she said, “will you make some berry cakes?”

Away she skipped, singing as she went down the lane and across the pasture. When she got to the woods, she put her lunch basket down beside a tree and began to pick berries. Rover ran about, chasing a squirrel and a rabbit, but never straying far from Susie.

The tin pail was not a very small one. By the time it was two thirds full, Susie began to feel hungry and thought she would eat her lunch. Rover came and took his place at her side as soon as she began to eat. Did she give him some of the lunch? No, she was in a selfish mood and did no such thing.

“There, Rover, run away! There’s a good dog,” she said, but Rover stayed near her, watching her steadily with his clear brown eyes. The meat he wanted so much was soon eaten up, and all he got of the nice lunch was a small crust of gingerbread that Susie threw away.

After lunch, Susie played for a while by the brook. She threw sticks into the water, and Rover swam in and brought them back. Then she began to pick berries again. She enjoyed the afternoon as much as she did the morning. The sunshine was as bright, the berries were as sweet and plentiful, and she was neither tired nor hungry.

Good, faithful Rover was hungry, and she had not given him even one piece of meat. She tried to forget how selfish she had been, but she could not do so, and quite early she started for home.

When she was nearly out of the woods, a rustling in the underbrush attracted her attention. “I wonder if that is a bird or a squirrel,” she said to herself. “If I can catch it, how glad I will be!” She tried to make her way quietly through the underbrush, but she was terrified when she saw a large snake coiled up before her prepared for a spring! She was frightened so much that she could not move, but brave Rover saw the snake, and, springing forward, scared it away. When the faithful dog came and rubbed his head against her hand, Susie put her arms around his neck, and burst into tears. “O Rover,” she cried, “you dear, good dog! How sorry I am that I was so selfish!”

Rover understood the tone of her voice, although he did not understand her words, and ran about happily, barking all the time. You can be sure that he had a big supper that evening.

Susie never forgot the lesson of that day. She soon learned to be on her guard against a selfish spirit and became a happier and more lovable little girl.

Harry and Annie

Harry and Annie lived a mile from town, but they went there to school every day. It was a pleasant walk down the lane and through the meadow by the pond. I hardly know whether they liked it better in summer or in winter. They used to pretend that they were travelers exploring a new country and would scatter leaves on the road so that they might find their way back again.

When the ice was thick and firm, they walked across the pond. But their mother did not like that they walked across the ice this unless someone was with them. "Don't go across the pond today, children," she said as she kissed them and bade them goodbye one morning; "it is beginning to thaw."

"All right, mother," said Harry, not very good-naturedly because he was very fond of running and sliding on the ice. When they came to the pond, the ice looked hard and safe. "There," he said to his sister. "I knew it hadn't thawed any. Mother is always afraid we will drown. Come along, we will have a good time sliding. The school bell will not ring for an hour at least."

"But you promised mother," said Annie.

"No, I didn't. I only said „All right," and it is all right."

"I didn't say anything, so I can do as I like," said Annie.

So they stepped on the ice, and started to go across the pond. They had not gone far before the ice gave way, and they fell into the water. A man who was at work near the shore heard the screams of the children and plunged into the water to save them. Harry managed to get to the shore without any help, but poor Annie nearly drowned before the man could reach her. Harry went home almost frozen and told his mother how disobedient he had been. He remembered the lesson learned that day as long as he lived.

Humming Birds

The most beautiful humming birds are found in the West Indies and South America. The crest of the tiny head of one of these birds shines like a sparkling crown of colored light. The shades of color that adorn its breast are equally brilliant. As the bird flits from one flower to another, it looks more like a bright flash of sunlight than it does a living being.

You ask, why are they called humming birds? It is because they make a soft, humming noise by the rapid motion of their wings—a motion so rapid, that as they fly, you can hardly see that they have wings.

One day when walking in the woods, I found the nest of one of the smallest humming birds. It was about half the size of a very small hen's egg, and it was attached to a twig no thicker than a steel knitting needle. It seemed to have been made of cotton fibers and was covered with the softest bits of leaf and bark. It had two eggs in it, and each was about as large as a small sugarplum.

When you approach the spot where one of these birds has built its nest, you need to be careful. The mother bird will dart at you and try to peck you. Its sharp beak may hurt you. The poor little thing knows no other way of defending its young, and instinct teaches it that you might carry off its nest if you find it.

The Lion and the Mouse

One day, a mighty lion caught a tiny mouse. The mouse begged, "Please let me go, and I will help you someday." The lion laughed but released him. Later, hunters trapped the lion in a net. The mouse heard his roar, ran to him, and gnawed the ropes until the lion was free.

The Eagle and the Farmer

A farmer once caught an eagle and clipped its wings to keep it as a pet. The eagle longed for freedom. One day, the farmer's friend restored its wings and set it free. The eagle soared high and later saw the farmer trapped in a pit. Out of gratitude, the eagle flew down and helped him escape.

The Dog and His Reflection

A dog carried a bone in his mouth while crossing a stream. Seeing his reflection, he thought another dog had a bigger bone. Greedy, he snapped at the reflection, dropping his own bone into the water.